

College Dropout

If you end up making money mistakes while in college, you usually hurt no one else but yourself. However, if you are married or if you share expenses with a roommate, your financial decisions will affect others. For example, if your roommate eats more than you do, is it fair to split the grocery bill in half? If bills can be divided according to the portion of the total bill that each person is responsible for, it is usually equitable. Unfortunately, this amount is sometimes not so easily determined and disagreements result. The worst thing to do is not talk about it. Only when the dispute is discussed can it ever hope to be resolved.

When the sharing of finances involves a spouse or a spouse-to-be, your decisions also will have a lasting impact on the other person, since you will be sharing a life together and not just a semester. Therefore, it becomes even more important to be open and honest about your shared financial responsibilities. Lack of communication can lead to consequences other than financial ones.

Bret and Kim met during their freshman year in college at Berkeley and it was love at first sight. They both were students in the engineering department and had big plans for the future. By their sophomore year, they were engaged. Kim's family was wealthy and she grew up living a privileged lifestyle in a high-income neighborhood in San Francisco. She always attended the best private schools and never lacked for anything she needed or wanted. Bret, on the other hand, was raised in a working class community in Fresno where he attended schools better known for their high dropout rate than a high academic record. Despite his surroundings, Bret studied all the time and was rewarded with a college scholarship.

Bret always felt inferior around Kim's parents and family. He felt he wasn't good enough because of his background and lack of money. These feelings of inadequacy never went away and he

